URBAN RENEWAL:
Regeneration, Conservation and Redevelopment

Urban Renewal

- A continuous process of remodeling older parts of urban areas, including their central business areas by means of rehabilitation and conservation as well as redevelopment.
- Urban Renewal' is American in Origin
- The emphasis is on those parts which have fallen below current standards of public acceptability:
  - the residential parts of the inner city,
  - in the central business district itself.
- The "Doughnut Effect"
- Brownfields??

Terminologies

- **Slum Clearance**
  - Demolition of dilapidated dwellings located in a slum (an area of sub-standard, overcrowded housing occupied by the poor immigrants)
- **Redevelopment**
  - The demolition of an existing building and its replacement by a new building
- **Rehabilitation**
  - The repair and improvement of existing structurally sound property

Terminologies

- **Housing Improvement**
  - Improvements of dwellings by provision of essential basic amenities
- **Conservation**
  - To retain intact or unchanged. Also meant as ‘Preservation’
- **Environmental Improvements**
  - Main emphasis is to improve environmental conditions
- **Economic Renewal**
  - Improvement of economic conditions of dwellers

Importance of Urban Renewal

- Urban areas are becoming larger and older
- Constant expansion of urban areas into agricultural hinterland
- Large quantities of urban land and buildings are abandoned and left dilapidated

1. Elimination of sub standard housing.
2. Revitalizing city economics.
3. Constructing good houses.

When is it needed?

- **Indicators for residential parts of inner cities are:**
  - inadequate housing,
  - environmental degradation,
  - presence of non-conforming uses.
- **Indicators for central business district are:**
  - traffic problems,
  - congestion,
  - dilapidated buildings.

Other Triggers…

- Effective functioning of Administrative towns (state, District)
- To accommodate an event of magnitude. (Olympics, FIFA etc. Festivals)
- Necessity due to natural /man-made calamity (Earthquake, Industrial Disaster)
- Obsolescence of land uses (Shifting of manufacturing industries)
- Market driven change of land use (Commercialization)
- To conserve historic monuments/ environment. (Areas around Mughal monuments)

Common Projects

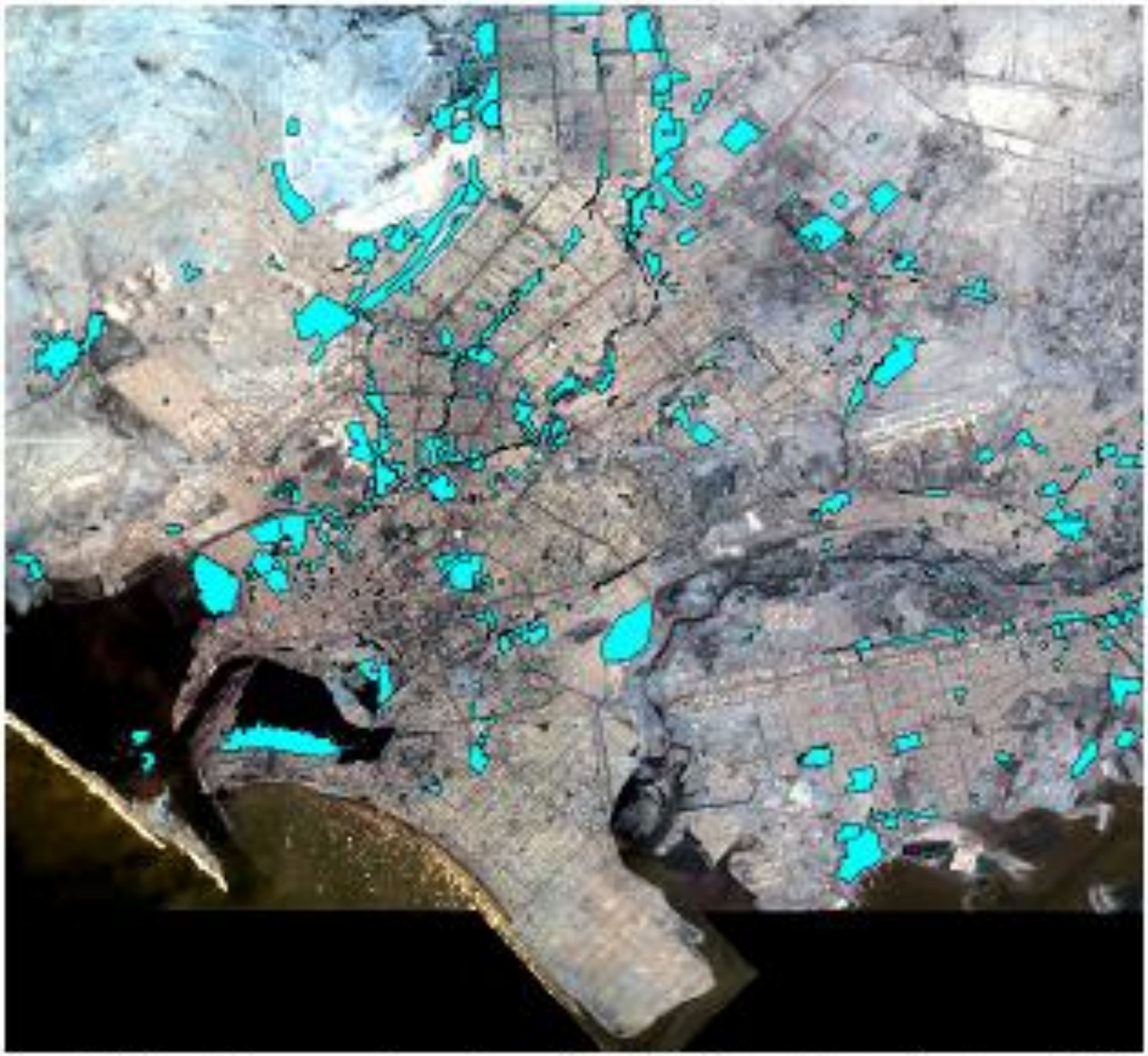
- **Following Projects fall under Urban Renewal:**
  - Redevelopment projects
  - Economic development strategies
  - Housing loans and other financial tools
  - Streetscape improvements
  - Transportation enhancement
  - Historic preservation projects
  - Parks and open spaces

Slums

- "A heavily populated urban area characterized by sub-standard housing and squalor" (UN-HABITAT).
- The characteristics associated with slums vary from context to context.
- Planned slums are created in two ways:
  - Plots allotted to low-income are soon sold to middle and high-income groups with high demand of services per capita. The services soon became insufficient causing breakdowns and eventually converting decent housing areas into planned slums.
  - Planned slums are also created by formal private sector by not providing the infrastructure services.

Characteristics of Slums

- **Still, they are usually characterized by:**
  - urban blight
  - high rates of poverty and unemployment
  - 'breeding grounds' for social problems such as crime, drug addiction, alcoholism, high rates of mental-illness, suicide etc.
  - high rates of disease due to unsanitary conditions, malnutrition and lack of basic health care.
  - inadequate access to safe water, sanitation and other infrastructure
  - poor structural quality of housing
  - overcrowding
  - insecure residential status
  - low socio-economic status



Katchi Abadis marked on Satellite data (Year 2005)

Other affiliated Terms

- **Squatter Settlements:** The only difference with Slum is that these settlements take birth on the lands of illegal appropriation.
- **Ghetto:** The difference is that the majority of the dwellers belongs to a certain racial, ethnic or religious group and is in minority as compared to the overall population.
- **Other terms are 'Katchi Abadis', 'Shanty Towns' and 'Favela'.**

Alternative Names

- Informal settlements
- Low-income settlements
- Semi-permanent settlements
- Spontaneous settlements
- Unauthorized settlements
- Unplanned settlements
- Uncontrolled settlements

Squatter Settlements in Pakistan

- Squatter settlements are termed by the word Katchi Abadis in the context of Pakistan.
- All settlements that were on illegal lands either of government or private sector, comprising a minimum number of 40 dwelling units as on or before 23 March, 1985 were declared as Katchi Abadis by Junejo Government.
- Ownership rights were transferred to the dwellers of Katchi Abadis with the binding that they could not sell their property before 5 years.
- Katchi Abadis on private lands were deleted in the documents as Katchi Abadis.
- Transferred Katchi Abadis were further mutated by the Revenue Department.

Legal Acts

- Punjab Katchi Abadis Act 1992
- KPK (Then NWFP) Katchi Abadis Act 1996
- Sindh Katchi Abadis 1987

Demographic Statistics for Katchi Abadis in 5 Major Cities of Punjab

Sr. No.	City	Number of Katchi Abadis	Data Available for no. of Katchi Abadis	No. of Housing Units	No. of Housing Units/ Katchi Abadi	Total No. of Housing Units
1	Lahore	308	172	44386	258	79482
2	Faisalabad	93	68	23564	347	32227
3	Gujranwala	32	24	3032	126	4043
4	Multan	32	20	6908	345	11053
5	Rawalpindi	8	4	2363	591	4726

Conservation

- **Preservation:** is a synonym for conservation. Generally, the term is applied to the urban mass and the built environment.
- **Restoration:** is a reverential restoration where a structure is restored to it's original state.
- **Renovation:** An original heritage building which has suffered insensitive changes and additions over the years is renovated for today's use with repair and up-gradation.
- **Re-use:** A building is renovated for a new use. This re-use is crucial for the preservation of architectural heritage.
- **Retrofitting?**

Economic Life of a Building

- Market defines economic life of a building
- According to Goodall (1972), a building will not be demolished so long as:

  $B_e > S_n$, where

  B_e is the present capital value of the real property, and

  S_n is the value of the cleared site

Economic Life of a Building

- **Be is determined as follows:**
  - **$B_e = Y_e - O_e$, where**
  - Y_e is the present capital value of earnings from the existing building, and
  - O_e is the present value of the operating costs of the existing building.

Economic Life of a Building

- **Sn is determined as follows:**
  - **$S_n = Y_n - C_n - O_n - D_e$, where**
  - Y_n is the present capital value of the expected earnings from the replacement building,
  - C_n is the cost of constructing the replacement building,
  - O_n is the present value of the operating costs of the new building, and
  - D_e is the cost of demolishing the old building and preparing the site.

Important Considerations

- **Following considerations/ costs have to be kept in mind:**
  - Anticipated rent that can be achieved for the building,
  - Energy and utility costs,
  - Repair and maintenance costs,
  - Demolition and site preparation costs (simple in a housing area, problematic in an industrial zone), and
  - Appropriate discount rate with which to bring all future costs and earnings back to a current value.

Physical Life of the Buildings

- There is no definable physical life of a building.
- In Britain, there are dwellings up to 400 years old still providing adequate accommodation, while local authority flats built in 1960s have already been demolished as they have reached their economic life.


THANK
YOU!